AI SEO Masterclass

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THE MONSTER AI SEO / LLM S...

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INTRODUCTION: WHY AI SEO IS NOT OPTIONAL

REPEAT AFTER ME:

AI SEO (GEO) is just SEO... with new distribution layers.

If you can't get featured and cited in 2026, you're not doing SEO—you're writing blog posts.

Most people will keep doing "old SEO" and wonder why traffic is flat.

That's the opportunity.

🎯 Learning Objectives

By the end of this Introduction, you will:

- Understand why AI SEO is the single most important shift in search since Google's founding
- Recognize the massive economic opportunity hiding in plain sight
- Internalize why traditional SEO tactics alone will leave you behind
- Commit to mastering both traditional AND AI-driven search optimization

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The New Reality: Search Has Fundamentally Changed

what most people miss: the *composition* of that revenue has shifted dramatically toward AI-optimized properties.

Here's what I've learned from 902 daily "Build in Public" episodes, running multiple 7-figure SEO businesses, and testing every AI SEO tactic before teaching it:

The game has changed irreversibly.

Think about how you search now. When you need to find the best software, research a purchase, or get advice on a complex topic—where do you go first? For millions of people, the answer is no longer Google. It's ChatGPT, Perplexity, Claude, or Google's own AI Overviews. This isn't a trend. This is a permanent behavioral shift.

The data is staggering. ChatGPT now has over 400 million weekly active users as of late 2025, up from 100 million just two years prior. Perplexity AI has crossed 15 million monthly active users and continues growing at double-digit monthly rates. Google's AI Overviews now appear in over 1.5 billion queries per day, fundamentally changing what users see before they ever click a traditional blue link.

But here's the critical insight most SEO "experts" are missing:

This isn't about replacing Google. It's about adding entirely new distribution layers that didn't exist before. AI search engines don't just rank pages—they synthesize answers from multiple sources and cite the brands they trust. When someone asks ChatGPT "what's the best local SEO tool," it doesn't show them a list of links. It gives them an answer, supported by citations.

If your brand isn't in those citations, you don't exist to AI searchers.

The Data You Need to Know

Ahrefs conducted the largest study of its kind, analyzing **26,283 URLs** across ChatGPT, Google AI Overviews, Perplexity, and other LLMs to understand exactly what gets cited and why.

Key findings:

- **43.8%** of all ChatGPT citations come from "Best X" listicles. Not research papers. Not news articles. Structured, ranked lists.
- **79.1%** of cited content was updated in the current year. Freshness isn't just a ranking factor—it's the dominant signal for AI citations.
- **Low-DR sites CAN rank and get cited** — structure matters more than raw domain authority in AI search
- **Self-promotional lists work** — when structured correctly, featuring your own brand prominently is not just allowed, it's effective
- **Freshness is EVERYTHING** — the AI models heavily weight recency over almost any other factor

This data reveals something profound: the barrier to entry in AI search is lower than traditional SEO, but the content requirements are more specific. You don't need a DR 90 domain to get cited by ChatGPT. You need the right structure, the right freshness signals, and the right positioning.

This is the greatest arbitrage opportunity in search history.

Why Most SEO Professionals Will Fail This Transition

I've watched the SEO industry react to every major shift—Panda, Penguin, the mobile-first index, Core Web Vitals. Most professionals adapt slowly, resist change, or outright deny the new reality until it's too late.

Here's what I'm seeing in 2026:

The majority of SEO professionals are still optimizing for Google's traditional algorithm while completely ignoring AI search optimization. They're building links to improve rankings on a results page that fewer people are seeing. They're writing



This creates a massive opportunity for you.

While competitors fight over shrinking traditional SERP real estate, you can establish yourself as THE cited source in AI responses. The businesses that master AI SEO in 2026 will have an insurmountable advantage for the next decade.

The window for early adoption is closing. As more brands wake up to this shift, competition for AI citations will intensify. The time to build your AI search presence is now, while the field is still relatively open.

My Results (So You Know This Works)

I don't teach theory. I teach what I've validated with my own money, time, and businesses.

Monthly Revenue Progression:

- 2014 = $450/mo
- 2015 = $1,500/mo
- 2016 = $3,500/mo
- 2017 = $10k/mo
- 2018 = $55k/mo
- 2019 = $45k/mo
- 2020 = $44k/mo
- 2021 = $208k/mo
- 2022 = $258k/mo
- 2023 = $223k/mo
- 2024 = $293k/mo
- 2025 = $243k/mo (43% net margins)

Recent Monthly Breakdowns:

- October 2025: $272,700
- September 2025: $235,675

Revenue sources (the actual businesses):

- Indexsy (SEO tool suite) — $50-100k/mo
- LocalRank.so + Trackings.ai — $60-90k/mo
- Version.so (web hosting) — $40-50k/mo
- Advise.so (community) — $20-50k/mo
- Amazon affiliate — $4-35k/mo
- OnlyFans (don't ask) — $15-25k/mo
- Mediavine — $2-4k/mo
- STR Lisbon — $8-23k/mo

Every single one of these revenue streams benefits from AI SEO. LocalRank.so exists because I identified the need for AI-optimized local SEO tools. Trackings.ai tracks LLM citations because I needed to measure my own AI search performance.

This course will show you EXACTLY how I did it.

What You'll Learn in This Course

This isn't another surface-level overview filled with recycled advice. This course covers EVERYTHING I've tested, validated, and systematized:

✅ Traditional SEO foundations (yes, you still need them—AI models crawl the same web)

✅ AI/LLM SEO (GEO) complete system—my exact framework for getting cited

✅ ChatGPT ranking in 10 days—the SOP I use to get cited within a week

defensible SEO moat

✅ Parasite SEO tactics (still working in 2026)

✅ Reddit & social SEO for LLM visibility

✅ Content strategy for AI dominance

✅ Real case studies with URLs and revenue breakdowns

By the end of this course, you won't just understand AI SEO—you'll have a complete implementation system that generates real results.

💡 Pro Tips

Pro Tip #1: The AI SEO Arbitrage Won't Last Forever

Early adopters of any platform always capture disproportionate returns. I was doing SEO in 2014 when you could rank with basic keyword stuffing. I built affiliate sites in 2018 when competition was a fraction of what it is now. AI SEO in 2026 is at that same inflection point. The tactics I teach work *now* because most competitors haven't caught on. In 2-3 years, these strategies will be standard practice. Execute now while the window is open.

Pro Tip #2: Don't Abandon Traditional SEO

I see people making two mistakes: ignoring AI SEO completely, or abandoning traditional SEO to focus only on AI. Both are wrong. AI models crawl and index the same web that Google does. If your technical SEO is broken, your content is thin, or your site architecture is confusing, AI models will struggle to understand and cite you. The foundation matters more than ever because AI can actually understand context at a deeper level than traditional algorithms.

Pro Tip #3: Freshness is Your Competitive Advantage

79.1% of AI citations go to content updated in the current year. Most businesses publish content and never touch it again. If you commit to a monthly update schedule—literally just changing the year, adding a new paragraph, and updating a statistic—

📋 Action Items

Before you move to Module 1, complete these foundational steps:

1. Audit your current search traffic sources

- Check Google Analytics 4 for "chat" in referral sources
- Look for chatgpt.com, perplexity.ai, and other AI referrers
- Document your baseline—most businesses are surprised how much AI traffic they're already getting

2. Set up brand monitoring

- Create a spreadsheet to track where and how your brand gets mentioned
- Search your brand name + "best" in ChatGPT, Perplexity, and Google
- Document the first page of results for your main keywords

3. Commit to the update schedule

- Calendar a monthly content refresh for your top 10 pages
- Set reminders for the first of each month
- Plan to update publish dates, statistics, and add 200-500 words of fresh content

4. Prepare your mindset

- Accept that AI SEO requires different thinking than traditional SEO
- Be willing to create content specifically designed for AI citation



🔑 Key Takeaways

- **AI SEO is not optional in 2026.** It's the single biggest shift in search since Google's founding, and early adopters will dominate the next decade.
- **The data doesn't lie.** 43.8% of ChatGPT citations come from structured listicles, and 79.1% of cited content is fresh. These are actionable insights, not theories.
- **Most competitors are asleep at the wheel.** They're fighting over shrinking traditional SERP real estate while ignoring AI search entirely. This creates massive arbitrage opportunity for you.
- **You need both traditional AND AI SEO.** AI models crawl the same web as Google. Broken fundamentals will sink your AI presence just as quickly as your Google rankings.
- **The window is closing.** AI SEO tactics work now because competition is low. In 2-3 years, everyone will be doing this. Execute while you have first-mover advantage.

Let's get started.